



Open. After reaching the pre-quarterfinals of the World Championship, he fell in the second round of five successive tournaments. Clearly, Lakshya has plenty to work on in 2024.

The year proved a forgettable one for K. Srikanth, the former No. 1 currently occupying the 24th spot. His best performances were his quarter-final appearances at the Spain Masters, Malaysia Masters, Indonesia Open, and Australian Open. In most tournaments in 2023, he lost in the second round. These include competitions like the Syed Modi India International.

P.V. Sindhu, too, battled fitness issues for the better part of a forgettable year. Starting 2023 as World No. 7, she slipped to 17 before finishing at 11. Out of 17 tournament appearances, Sindhu lost in the opening round of seven of her first 13 outings this year. In 50 matches,

Marching forward: The never-say-die spirit of H. S. Prannoy elevated the profile of Indian badminton in 2023. PTI

she won 28 and lost 22.

Interestingly, even without winning a single title in 2023, Sindhu figured in Forbes' 20 Highest Paid Female Athletes for the Year. Not surprisingly, she was the only Indian on that list, with estimated earnings of \$7.1 million. She struggled with a stress fracture suffered at the 2022 Commonwealth Games. After a five-match layoff, she made an unimpressive comeback. Due to poor results, she parted ways with Korean coach Park Tae-Sang and hired Malaysian Muhammad Hafiz Hashim, who later made way for Indonesian Agus Dwi Santoso.

Two-time Olympic medallist Sindhu, 28, is focused on getting it



Highlights of 2023

Chirag Shetty and Satwiksairaj Rankireddy became World No. 1 in men's doubles

Chirag-Satwik won the Asian title
H. S. Prannoy won the bronze medal in the World championship